

RICHARD BRETTON

Senior Product Owner | Technical Product Owner | Product Operations

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical Product Owner and product-delivery leader with 3+ years of direct product ownership and 6+ years of combined Agile delivery experience across enterprise web platforms, marketing technology, and game development. Turns complex ideas into products teams can actually ship by mapping work from concept to delivery: milestones, dependencies, decision gates, acceptance criteria, risk, and clear sequencing, so teams know what matters, what comes next, and what done looks like. Bridges business and engineering, simplifies brittle systems into self-service workflows, and builds operating models that accelerate delivery without sacrificing quality. At SelectQuote, doubled sprint output through developer enablement, increased marketing content output by 70% with self-service deployment tooling, and cut content turnaround time by 60%. As founder of Shattered Games Studios, applies the same discipline to a full Unreal Engine 5 production. Strongest where product strategy, technical fluency, operating discipline, and delivery leadership overlap.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Product Strategy: Roadmap Ownership, Backlog Prioritization, Stakeholder Alignment, Business Logic Rationalization, Data-Driven Decision Making

Systems & Operations: Dependency Mapping, Product Operations, Delivery Governance, Decision Frameworks, Risk & Scope Management, Definition of Done

Agile Leadership: Sprint Planning, Developer Enablement, Cross-Functional Delivery, Acceptance Criteria, Technical Discovery, Executive/Engineering Translation

Technical Acumen: CI/CD Pipelines, CMS Architecture, Rules Engines, A/B Testing, Analytics Instrumentation, AI/LLM Workflow Optimization, Unreal Engine

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

CMS & Content Platforms: Contentful (Certified Content Manager)

Analytics & Tagging: Google Tag Manager, GA360, Google Analytics, Segment

Experimentation: Optimizely (A/B and multivariate testing)

Delivery & DevOps: CI/CD Pipelines, Git, GitHub, BitBucket

Product & Collaboration: Jira, Confluence, Asana, Notion, Nuclino

AI & Emerging Tech: LLM Workflow Optimization, Claude, Claude Code (custom skills)

Engineering Foundations: Unreal Engine 5, .NET / C#

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Digital Product Owner

Mar 2025 – Jul 2026

SelectQuote

Remote

- Led design and delivery of a Contentful deployment tool that increased marketing content output by 70% and enabled Marketing to publish independently, removing developer intervention from the deployment workflow.
- Replaced convoluted, high-maintenance business logic with a new rules engine, converting recurring developer/PO clarification cycles into a self-service reference and roughly doubling the speed of business-logic decisions across teams.
- Trained developers across 3 teams on complex proprietary systems, doubling sprint deliverable output (200%) for committed projects.
- Guided senior and executive stakeholders through decisions on complex business logic, translating between engineering and business while driving architecture discussions that enabled faster, informed decisions.
- Led a user-experience initiative culminating in a redesigned web-form experience; A/B and multivariate testing increased user engagement by 12% and form completion by 18%.
- Co-led consolidation of 13 Contentful spaces, eliminating redundant and outdated content models and enabling direct production publishing, cutting content turnaround time by 60%.

- Created 3 development lifecycle processes that improved team efficiency by 20%, and co-led delivery-infrastructure modernization across 17 repositories and a new CI/CD pipeline that reduced release deployment to approximately 30 minutes.
- Led a GTM/GA360 tracking refactor that improved marketing-data accuracy by more than 40%, and transformed LLM-driven search and analytics workflows, improving data accuracy by 30%.

IT Project Manager II & Web Product Owner

Jul 2022 – Mar 2025

SelectQuote

Remote

- Partnered with DevOps and software engineering teams to automate deployment pipelines, reducing deployment time by 75% and removing manual release bottlenecks.
- Collaborated with IT and business leadership on project reporting and operating improvements that increased process efficiency by 13%.
- Led an Agile team in prioritizing deliverables and scoping key features, contributing to an 8% sales increase in February 2023.
- Coordinated marketing initiatives across 6+ departments, increasing brand visibility by 10% and stakeholder engagement by 15%.

SELECTED PRODUCT / TECHNICAL PROJECT

Eclipse of Hearts – Video Game

Jul 2025 – Present

Shattered Games Studios | Founder & Product Manager

Baldwin City, KS

- Designing and developing a dual-protagonist Souls-like action RPG in Unreal Engine 5.8, built on the Ascent Combat Framework (ACF) and Gameplay Ability System (GAS), spanning combat, combo graphs, stagger/poise, enemy AI, animation, damage calculation, and targeting.
- Own the production map end to end: milestone roadmap, dependency sequencing, fixed Definition-of-Done gates, and evidence-based graduation criteria using source, editor, and playtest verification before systems ship; 8 milestones delivered to date.
- Turn ambiguous technical problems into bounded investigations, decision gates, acceptance criteria, and implementation-ready work, using explicit stop conditions to avoid rabbit holes and unproven custom paths.
- Planned and executed a mid-project engine/framework migration (UE 5.8 / ACF 4.3.5) through a documented side-by-side evaluation process, preserving shipped systems with a frozen rollback repository.
- Built a multi-layer knowledge-governance system with canonical decision records, build invariants, implementation sheets, and a 600+ entry lessons-learned corpus, enabling consistent and auditable architecture decisions over a long-running production.
- Integrated AI across the production pipeline for architecture documentation, design governance, roadmap work, and source-level framework investigation using Claude and Claude Code with custom skills.
- Defined vertical-slice scope with documented guidelines and acceptance criteria, enforcing scope discipline and deferring non-essential work while repeatedly closing milestone scope ahead of the planned schedule.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **PSPO-I: Professional Scrum Product Owner** — Scrum.org
- **PSM-I: Professional Scrum Master** — Scrum.org
- **Google Project Management Certificate** — Google Career Certificates
- **Certified Content Manager** — Contentful
- **Claude 101 / Claude Code in Action** — Anthropic Academy
- **MCTS** — .NET Framework

EDUCATION

Application Development using .NET Framework

2011

Centriq Training | Computer Science